Valley Build-A-Biz LLC

Onboarding Packet

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% March 2026

VALLEY BUILD-A-BIZ LLC

ONBOARDING PACKET

Prepared for: Desirae Espinosa
Business Name: Valley Build-A-Biz LLC
Date: March 2026

This packet contains everything you need to complete your LLC setup and start serving clients. Work through each section in order.

SECTION 1: QUICK START CHECKLIST

Print or save this page. Check off each phase as you complete it:

- ☐ PHASE 1: LLC Formation (Week 1)
- ☐ PHASE 2: Federal EIN (Day 2-3)
- ☐ PHASE 3: Business Bank Account (Week 1-2)
- ☐ PHASE 4: Business Essentials (Week 2)
- ☐ PHASE 5: Online Presence Basics (Week 2-3)
- ☐ PHASE 6: Grant Application Prep (Week 3-4)
- ☐ PHASE 7: Client Outreach (Week 4+)

SECTION 2: ARTICLES OF ORGANIZATION

Colorado Limited Liability Company

INSTRUCTIONS: Complete this form and file with the Colorado Secretary of State.

Section A: Entity Information

Entity Name:

_____

(If the above name is unavailable, use this backup name:)

_____

Principal Address:

_____

City: _____ State: Colorado ZIP: _____

Section B: Registered Agent

You can serve as your own registered agent in Colorado, or use a professional service.

[ ] **I will serve as the registered agent** (Complete Section B1)

[ ] **I will use a registered agent service** (Complete Section B2)

B1 - If serving as your own registered agent:

Registered Agent Name: _____

Registered Agent Address: _____

City: _____ State: Colorado ZIP: _____

B2 - If using a registered agent service:

Service Company Name: _____

Service Address: _____

Section C: Organizer Information

Organizer Name: _____

Organizer Address: _____

City: _____ State: _____ ZIP: _____

Section D: Management Structure

Select one:

[ ] **Member-Managed** – Members (owners) manage the LLC directly

[ ] **Manager-Managed** – A designated manager (who may or may not be a member) handles day-to-day operations

Section E: Purpose Clause

The purpose of this LLC is to engage in any lawful business activity permitted in the State of Colorado.

Section F: Filing Information

Effective Date: Upon filing

Filing Fee: $50 (payable to Colorado Secretary of State)

Where to File: https://sos.state.co.us/biz

FILING CHECKLIST

Before submitting, ensure you have:

- ☐ Completed Entity Name (Section A)
- ☐ Completed Principal Address (Section A)
- ☐ Designated Registered Agent (Section B)
- ☐ Completed Organizer Information (Section C)
- ☐ Selected Management Structure (Section D)
- ☐ Signed and dated below

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Printed Name: _____

SECTION 3: FEDERAL EIN APPLICATION

IRS Employer Identification Number

INSTRUCTIONS: Apply online at https://www.irs.gov/ein

Application Fields

Legal Name of Business: Valley Build-A-Biz LLC

Trade Name (DBA): _____

Owner Information:

Name: _____

Social Security Number (for verification): *--_____

Business Address:

Street Address: _____

City: _____ State: Colorado ZIP: _____

County: San Luis Valley

Business Activity: Other Consulting

NAICS Code: 541600 (Other Management Consulting)

Date Business Started: _____

Entity Type: Limited Liability Company

State Where LLC Was Formed: Colorado

EIN CONFIRMATION

Your EIN: _____

Date Obtained: _____

Save this letter – You will need it to open your bank account.

SECTION 4: BANK ACCOUNT OPENING CHECKLIST

Required Documents

Bring these to the bank:

- ☐ EIN Letter (CP 575) from IRS
- ☐ Articles of Organization (filed copy from Colorado SOS)
- ☐ Valid government-issued photo ID (driver's license or passport)
- ☐ Initial deposit ($0-$100)

Bank Options

Bank	Website	Notes
Your existing personal bank	—	Easiest if you have a relationship
Discover Business Banking	https://www.discover.com/business-banking/	No fees for 12 months
Blue Ridge Bank	https://www.blueridgebank.com/	Community-focused

After Opening Your Account

- ☐ Activate online banking
- ☐ Enable account alerts (daily balance recommended)
- ☐ Download mobile app
- ☐ Order checks (optional)
- ☐ Record account number: _____

SECTION 5: BUSINESS ESSENTIALS SETUP

Step 5.1: Business Phone Number

Option A: Google Voice (FREE)

1. Go to https://voice.google.com
2. Sign in with your business Gmail
3. Click "Get a voice number"
4. Search for an available number (consider Colorado area code: 719 or 720)
5. Complete setup

Your Business Phone: _____

Step 5.2: Business Email

Option: Free Gmail

1. Go to https://mail.google.com
2. Create new account: valleybuildabiz@gmail.com

Your Business Email: _____

Step 5.3: Email Signature Template

Use this format for all business emails:

```
[Your Name]
Owner, Valley Build-A-Biz LLC

Phone: [Your Business Phone]
Email: [Your Business Email]
Website: [Your Future Website]

"Growing small businesses in the San Luis Valley"
```

Step 5.4: Calendly Setup

1. Go to https://calendly.com
2. Sign up for free account
3. Connect your Google Voice number
4. Create event type: "Free Consultation" (15 or 30 minutes)
5. Add booking questions:
   - Business name
   - What service are you interested in?
   - Current challenges

Your Calendly Link: https://calendly.com/_____

SECTION 6: ONLINE PRESENCE SETUP

Step 6.1: Google Business Profile

1. Go to https://business.google.com
2. Sign in with business Gmail
3. Add business name: "Valley Build-A-Biz LLC"
4. Select category: "Business Consulting"
5. Add address and service area (San Luis Valley)
6. Add phone number
7. Add website or Calendly link
8. Verify by postcard or phone

Step 6.2: LinkedIn Company Page

1. Go to https://linkedin.com/company
2. Click "Create"

3. Enter:
   - Name: Valley Build-A-Biz LLC
   - Tagline: "Growing small businesses in the San Luis Valley"
   - Industry: Business Consulting
   - Company size: 1-10 employees
4. Add description: "Helping small businesses in the San Luis Valley grow through strategic planning, grant assistance, and business development."

Your LinkedIn URL: _____

Step 6.3: Facebook Business Page (Optional)

1. Go to https://facebook.com/pages/create
2. Select "Local Business" or "Business"
3. Enter business name and details

SECTION 7: GRANT APPLICATION PREPARATION

Step 7.1: Amber Grant

1. Go to https://womensnet.org/amber-grant/
2. Click "Apply Now" or "Sign Up"
3. Create account with business email
4. Fill out business profile

Login: _____ Password: _____

Step 7.2: IFundWomen

1. Go to https://ifundwomen.com
2. Click "Apply" or "Sign Up"
3. Create account
4. Fill out profile
5. Connect bank account
6. Upload pitch deck

Login: _____ Password: _____

SECTION 8: ONBOARDING QUESTIONNAIRE

Your Story – Grant Application Foundation

Complete this questionnaire thoughtfully. Grant committees fund people, not just businesses. Your story is what makes the difference.

_____

Section 1: Background & Origins

1.1 Where did you grow up, and what was your childhood like?

_____

_____

_____

1.2 Who were the most influential people in your early life?

_____

_____

_____

1.3 What did you want to be when you grew up?

_____

_____

_____

Section 2: The Spark

2.1 When did you first realize you wanted to help small businesses?

_____

_____

_____

2.2 What specific struggle did you witness that nobody was addressing?

_____

_____

_____

2.3 What would have changed everything for you at that moment?

_____

_____

_____

Section 3: Your Superpowers

3.1 What skills or experiences do you have that most business consultants don't?

_____

_____

_____

3.2 What's something you've done that you're genuinely proud of?

_____

_____

_____

3.3 How do you work with clients differently than a typical business advisor?

_____

_____

_____

Section 4: The Problem You See

4.1 What struggles do small businesses in the San Luis Valley face that nobody is addressing?

_____

_____

_____

4.2 What have you noticed about how business owners in this valley think about growth?

_____

_____

4.3 What's the cost of these problems? (Personal, business, community impact)

_____

_____

_____

Section 5: Your Vision

5.1 What does success look like for Valley Build-A-Biz LLC?

- 1 year: _____
- 3 years: _____
- 5 years: _____

5.2 What does success look like for your clients?

_____

_____

5.3 What does success look like for the San Luis Valley community?

_____

_____

_____

Section 6: Turning Points

6.1 What's the biggest failure or setback you've experienced—and what did it teach you?

_____

_____

6.2 Have you ever had to pivot?

_____

_____

6.3 What's your biggest breakthrough so far?

_____

_____

Section 7: Why You

7.1 Why are YOU the one to solve this problem?

_____

_____

7.2 What would happen if Valley Build-A-Biz didn't exist?

_____

_____

_____

Section 8: Community Connection

8.1 How are you embedded in the San Luis Valley community?

_____

_____

8.2 Who do you know in the Valley that could vouch for you?

_____

_____

_____

Section 9: Milestones

9.1 What are your biggest wins—so far—even small ones?

_____

_____

9.2 What awards, certifications, or recognition have you received?

_____

_____

Section 10: Motivations

10.1 What drives you? (Rank: 1 = most important)

- ☐ Financial independence
- ☐ Making an impact in my community
- ☐ Helping specific people
- ☐ Building something that outlasts me
- ☐ Proving something to myself or others
- ☐ Freedom and flexibility
- ☐ Family legacy

10.2 What does a "good life" look like for you?

_____

10.3 What are you most afraid of in starting this business?

_____

_____

Section 11: Personal Details

Contact Information:

- Full Name: _____
- Business Name: Valley Build-A-Biz LLC
- Email: _____
- Phone: _____
- Website: _____
- LinkedIn: _____
- Facebook: _____
- Instagram: _____

Business Details:

- Date Formed: _____
- Entity Type: LLC
- State of Formation: Colorado
- EIN: _____
- Business Address: _____

Emergency Contact:

- Name: _____
- Relationship: _____
- Phone: _____

SECTION 9: OUTREACH TEMPLATES

Cold Email Template

Subject: Quick question about [BUSINESS NAME]

Hi [CONTACT NAME],

I'm [YOUR NAME] with Valley Build-A-Biz LLC — we help small businesses in the San Luis Valley and across Colorado get found online and run more efficiently.

I noticed [BUSINESS NAME] doesn't have a website yet, and that's costing you customers every day. Most people search Google before they ever call or visit.

We offer: - **Professional websites** — $500 one-time, $20/mo hosting - **Google Business Profile optimization** — so you show up in local searches - **Mobile apps** — custom apps for orders, appointments, customer management

I'd love to offer you a **free 15-minute call** to chat about what's holding your business back online. No pressure, no sales pitch — just a conversation.

Would you have time this week to talk?

Best,
[YOUR NAME]
Valley Build-A-Biz LLC
[PHONE NUMBER]

SMS Template

Message:

Hi [NAME]! This is [YOUR NAME] from Valley Build-A-Biz LLC. We help small businesses in the San Luis Valley get found online. Would you have 5 minutes for a quick chat? No pressure — just want to learn about your business. Let me know!

SECTION 10: RESOURCE REFERENCE

Resource	Link
Colorado Secretary of State	https://sos.state.co.us/biz
IRS EIN	https://www.irs.gov/ein
Discover Business Banking	https://www.discover.com/business-banking/
Google Voice	https://voice.google.com
Calendly	https://calendly.com
Google Business Profile	https://business.google.com
LinkedIn	https://linkedin.com/company
Amber Grant	https://womensnet.org/amber-grant/
IFundWomen	https://ifundwomen.com

SECTION 11: TROUBLESHOOTING

Name already taken: Use backup name "Build-A-Biz LLC" or try "Valley Build-A-Biz Consulting LLC"

Bank won't open account: Ensure you have your EIN letter and Articles of Organization. Some banks require both.

Can't verify Google Voice: Make sure you're using a new Gmail account, not your personal one.

Grants reject you: First few rejections are normal. Refine your story and try again next month.

No responses to outreach: Vary your message, try calling instead of texting, ask for referrals.

COMPLETION SIGN-OFF

Phase	Date Completed	Initials
Phase 1: LLC Formation	_____	_____
Phase 2: Federal EIN	_____	_____
Phase 3: Business Bank Account	_____	_____
Phase 4: Business Essentials	_____	_____
Phase 5: Online Presence	_____	_____
Phase 6: Grant Prep	_____	_____
Phase 7: Client Outreach	_____	_____

Document prepared by Valley Build-A-Biz LLC
Last updated: March 2026